This broth is best with a puff-pastry lid on each bowl. As you break the lid, the spicy aroma is unleashed. The broth itself is best if you make it the day before.

# spiced lamb broth

**SERVES** 4 **PREP** 30 MINS **COOK** 2 HRS 30 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS WITHOUT THE PASTRY LID

1½ quarts (1½ liters) chicken stock
12oz (350g) lamb shank
9oz (250g) lamb neck fillet, cut into 1¾in (4cm) pieces
2 onions, coarsely chopped
2in (5cm) piece of ginger, peeled and chopped
5 garlic cloves, halved
1 tsp cumin seeds, dry-roasted (see p25)
½ tsp cloves
2 bay leaves
2in (5cm) cinnamon stick
8 green cardamoms, crushed
1 large brown cardamom, crushed
¼ tsp black peppercorns
1 blade mace
sea salt
1 tbsp vegetable oil
9oz (250g) button mushrooms, sliced
1 green chile, seeded and shredded
13oz (375g) ready-to-use puff pastry
1 egg, beaten

1 Pour the stock into a large pan with the lamb, onions, ginger, garlic, and spices. Season with salt and bring to a boil. Partially cover, then simmer for 2 hours or until the meat is tender and the broth reduced by one-third. Cool, then remove the lamb with a slotted spoon and cut into small pieces.

2 Strain the broth through a sieve into a clean pan, pressing the ingredients against the sides of the sieve to extract maximum flavor. Bring to a fast boil and season with salt. Meanwhile, heat the oil in a frying pan and cook the mushrooms and chile for 5 minutes or until just starting to color. Add to the broth, along with the lamb. If you're working a day ahead, set aside to cool, then chill in the refrigerator. Remove the fat from the surface the next day.

3 Preheat the oven to 425˚F (220˚C). Almost fill four ovenproof bowls with broth. Cut four circles—about 1in (2.5cm) wider than the bowls—from the pastry. Brush the lip and edge of the bowls with egg and cover with the pastry lids. Each should have an overhang—press this down the sides of the bowl to seal. Brush the top and sides of the lid with egg, make a small hole in the top of each one, and bake for 15–20 minutes, or until golden and crisp.